3 Books That Make You Disgustingly Good at Marketing

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 13, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/DZiWTfYNTkI Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter recommends three marketing books in escalating order of power — Influence, Expert Secrets, and Breakthrough Advertising — explaining why each one sharpens a different critical marketing skill.

📑 Contents

- 📖 Book 1: Influence by Robert Cialdini
- 🧠 Book 2: Expert Secrets by Russell Brunson
- 💡 Book 3: Breakthrough Advertising by Eugene Schwartz
- 🤖 Bonus: Brandon Carter's Own Book

📖 Book 1: Influence by Robert Cialdini 0:00

- Core concept: Cialdini calls his framework **"weapons of influence"** — psychological triggers that drive human behavior
  - The six triggers covered in the book:
    - Reciprocity — people feel compelled to give back when given something
    - Social proof — people follow what others are doing
    - Scarcity — limited availability increases desire
    - Authority — people trust credible experts
    - Unity — shared identity creates connection
    - Commitment — people stay consistent with prior decisions
- Practical payoff: once you learn these triggers, you begin noticing them daily in the world around you
  - You can then deliberately apply them in your own marketing to earn more money and attract more customers

🧠 Book 2: Expert Secrets by Russell Brunson 0:22

- Author: Russell Brunson, whom Carter identifies as one of his own mentors
- Core idea: people don't just buy your product or service — **they buy you and your story**
  - Your personal story is a differentiator that competitors cannot replicate

- What the book teaches:
  - How to tell your story in an authentic way that genuinely sets you apart from competitors
- Carter's assessment:
  - Calls it one of the best books on copywriting available
  - Describes it as essential reading for every entrepreneur

💡 Book 3: Breakthrough Advertising by Eugene Schwartz 0:44

- Pricing signal: people pay **$300–$400** for this book on the secondary market, reflecting its rarity and demand
- Reputation: widely considered the foundational reference for all modern marketing and advertising
- Core framework: Schwartz defines **five levels of customer awareness**
  - The key skill is knowing exactly where your prospect sits within those five levels
  - Failing to identify the correct level means you risk saying the wrong thing to the wrong person — and losing the sale

🤖 Bonus: Brandon Carter's Own Book 1:05

- Title: *7-Day AI Business Plan* — written specifically for online personal trainers
- Purpose: shows fitness coaches how to start growing an online fitness business within 7 days using artificial intelligence
- Positioned as a self-promotional mention separate from the three main recommendations